

Miners Gear For Invasion

Southern Colorado, Denver, CSU Visit Town

by MARK LEIBSON
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It's time for Colorado schools to invade Dudley Field against the University of Texas at El Paso baseball Miners.

Having completed its schedule with Texas schools (Texas Tech and Hardin Simmons University) Coach Andy Cohen's 7-4 Miners host Southern Colorado Wednesday and Thursday at 1 p.m. before Denver University rolls into El Paso for doubleheaders Friday and Saturday.

Colorado State's Rams take on U.T. El Paso Monday but since the Rams and Miners are in different divisions in the Western Athletic Conference, the games will not be counted towards their league standings.

As for Cohen and his players, the next two weeks will be aimed at building up the team's confidence. "We have to build our confidence," explained Cohen, "I'm trying

to get the boys mentally prepared so when Arizona State comes here to begin WAC play, we won't be afraid of them."

One way to build the moral and confidence of the players would be a long winning streak, but Cohen does not have that in mind. "Sure it's nice to win, but as long as we're playing good baseball, and we know it, I think we'll be ready for ASU."

The Western Athletic Conference schedule opens for the Miners in Tucson with a three-game set against the University of Arizona on April 4-5. The following weekend, ASU invades Dudley Field for three.

"I'm real impressed with the way our kids looked in Texas Tech," praised Cohen. "Tech has a big field and our boys hit some shots that would have cleared the fence at Dudley by 40 feet, but the wind over there held the ball in the park."

If U.T. El Paso's hitting starts coming

around, the Miners should have a well-balanced team. From the pitching aspect of the game, Cohen probably has the best staff that he's ever had since taking over the helm.

"Our pitching has probably been the most steady part of our game," acknowledged Cohen. "Dan Modlinski pitched another good game in Lubbock this second victory over the Red Raiders of Texas Tech) but Ron Wrobel wasn't able to get loosened up."

Modlinski and Wrobel, both from Chicago, are the one-two punch Cohen is relying on once WAC competition begins next month.

"You can't forget George Landreth either," reminded Cohen. "He pitched a heck of a game against Tech."

The lefthander hurled shutout ball for nine innings against the Red Raiders two weeks ago but an unearned run forced Landreth to take the setback.